



Adopting a Growth Mindset at the Workplace

Two Ways to Think About Ability



Fixed Mindset

- Abilities are fixed traits
- Avoids challenges that risk failure
- Sees feedback as personal criticism
- Treats failure as proof of inability



Growth Mindset

- Abilities can be developed with effort
- Embraces challenges as opportunities
- Sees feedback as useful information
- Treats failure as data for learning

Why It Matters at Work



Adaptability

Teams adjust faster when change is treated as normal, not a threat.



Stronger Collaboration

Open, honest feedback builds trust across teams.



Resilience

Setbacks become recoverable instead of defining.

Embrace Challenges Instead of Avoiding Them

How to do it

- Volunteer for one unfamiliar project this quarter
- Ask 'what can I learn here?' before judging difficulty
- Set one stretch goal just beyond your comfort zone



REAL-LIFE EXAMPLE

Microsoft — Satya Nadella

When Satya Nadella became CEO in 2014, he pushed Microsoft to shift from a 'know-it-all' culture to a 'learn-it-all' one - encouraging employees to take on unfamiliar work instead of only protecting their existing expertise. The shift is widely credited with reviving the company's innovation.

Treat Feedback as a Growth Tool



REAL-LIFE EXAMPLE

Netflix's Culture of Candor

Netflix built its culture around direct, honest feedback - employees are encouraged to give and receive candid input openly rather than saving concerns for a formal review. This habit of fast, transparent feedback is often credited with helping the company adapt quickly.

How to do it

- Ask for specific, actionable feedback - not just “how am I doing?”
- Pause and say “thank you” before reacting
- Separate the message from your ego: it's about the work, not your worth

Reframe Failure as a Learning Step

How to do it

- After a setback, ask: “what did this teach me?”
- Keep a short ‘lessons learned’ note for each project
- Judge effort and strategy first, outcome second



REAL-LIFE EXAMPLE

Edison & Amazon's Bezos

Thomas Edison tested thousands of materials before perfecting the light bulb, treating each failed attempt as useful data rather than defeat. More recently, Amazon's Jeff Bezos has spoken about how costly misses - like the Fire Phone - informed the bets that led to successes such as Alexa.

Commit to Continuous Learning



REAL-LIFE EXAMPLE

Google's '20% Time'

Google's well-known '20% time' policy let engineers spend part of their week on self-directed learning and side projects, a practice that contributed to products like Gmail. Many companies now offer similar learning stipends or platforms such as LinkedIn Learning to keep skills current.

How to do it

- Block 30 minutes a week for upskilling
- Learn one thing from a colleague outside your team
- Pick one new skill to build each quarter

Make It a Daily Habit



Daily

Catch one fixed-mindset thought and reframe it: swap 'I can't' for 'I can't yet.'



Weekly

Ask one colleague or manager for specific feedback on recent work.



Monthly

Review one setback and write down exactly what it taught you.



Quarterly

Pick one new skill to learn and block time on your calendar for it.



Growth Is a Practice, Not a Destination

Every challenge you take on, every piece of feedback you welcome, and every setback you examine builds the habit. Start with one small step today.

Thank You